

Syed Fahad Hussain Zaidi

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SUMMARY

Cloud Security Engineer with 4+ years securing Azure and AWS environments across identity, endpoint, network, and data security, with a track record of building the internal tooling and automation that security operations run on rather than only operating vendor products. Experienced designing IAM and Zero Trust controls, running SIEM-based detection and response, and using Infrastructure as Code and AI-assisted development to turn manual security processes into repeatable systems. Holds Microsoft Certified: Azure Infrastructure Solutions and CompTIA Security+ certifications, currently pursuing AZ-500.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Cloud Platforms: Microsoft Azure (Entra ID, Sentinel, Defender, Intune, Azure Virtual Desktop, Landing Zones, ExpressRoute, VNETs), AWS (GuardDuty, CloudTrail, EKS, IAM, CloudFormation), Microsoft 365

Identity & Access Management: MFA, SSO, RBAC, PIM, Conditional Access, PAM, Microsoft Graph PowerShell

Endpoint & Network Security: SentinelOne, EDR, application whitelisting, IDS/IPS, VPNs, NAC, web filtering, firewalls

Security Operations: SIEM (Microsoft Sentinel), log management, vulnerability management, threat hunting, incident response, eDiscovery

Automation & Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, ARM templates, Bicep, PowerShell, Azure DevOps, DevSecOps practices

AI-Assisted Engineering: Rapid prototyping and internal tool development with Claude/Cowork, OpenAI Codex, Devin, and Replit; workflow automation with AI agents (Hermes Agent)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Infrastructure Solutions
- CompTIA Security+ ce Certification

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Savvital

Jun 2022 – Present

Cloud Security Engineer

Islamabad, Pakistan

- Cut endpoint malware exposure 60%+ across Azure Virtual Desktop by deploying and tuning EDR, device control, and application whitelisting. Quarantined 3,000+ malware instances.
- Tuned Defender for Office 365 and Exchange Online threat policies across 180,000+ scanned emails, mostly to fix a false-positive problem without losing real phishing and malware catches.
- Triageed and investigated 1,000+ security alerts through Microsoft Sentinel and endpoint telemetry, prioritized by risk.
- Resolved 2,000+ IT and security service requests at a 95% resolution rate.
- Ran identity security in Entra ID, MFA, Conditional Access, RBAC, PIM, least-privilege access without making people's login painful.
- Built a database-backed dashboard for client onboarding/issue tracking, covering check-ins, reported issues, timestamps, and resolutions.
- Automated recurring Microsoft 365 identity work, bulk group membership and calendar-sharing changes, with Microsoft Graph and PowerShell.
- Automated onboarding and service-request workflows with AI agents (Hermes Agent) and Claude-based tooling.
- Rolled out Azure Landing Zone architecture with ExpressRoute as the standard pattern for new workloads.
- Provisioned and hardened Azure resources with Terraform, ARM, and Bicep, which cut down on configuration drift between environments.

- Built incident response around Microsoft 365 audit logs, eDiscovery, and Microsoft Purview, including eDiscovery permissions and formal incident reports.
- Set up Azure backup and recovery on Blob, Queue, and Table Storage, and handled the risk assessment and audit-prep side of compliance.

Roots International Schools

Feb 2021 – Feb 2022

IT Officer

Islamabad, Pakistan

- Configured and managed firewalls, IDS/IPS, and Azure VPNs, reducing unauthorized network access incidents.
- Monitored endpoints and Active Directory for vulnerabilities, using identity and access management controls to prevent security breaches.
- Ran data backup and disaster recovery operations that maintained data integrity and minimized downtime during system failures.
- Authored IT process and systems documentation that improved team efficiency and standardized compliance with security protocols.

PROJECTS

Secsailor, Internal Cloud Security Decision-Support Platform (personal project)

Problem: cloud service selection, architecture, and security decisions across AWS, Azure, and GCP were made ad hoc, with no shared reference for which service or pattern fit a given scenario. Built an internal tool that codifies decision criteria for service selection, architecture choice, and security considerations across common integration, migration, and cloud-adoption scenarios — giving a repeatable, documented basis for cloud architecture and security recommendations.

Threat Detection with AWS GuardDuty — Jan 2025

Deployed an intentionally vulnerable web application (OWASP Juice Shop) via AWS CloudFormation to build a controlled environment for cloud security testing. Ran simulated attacks against the environment and evaluated GuardDuty's detection and reporting accuracy against known attack patterns.

AWS Security Monitoring Pipeline — Mar 2025

Configured CloudTrail logging and CloudWatch alarms with SNS notifications to build an end-to-end audit and alerting pipeline for AWS account activity. Validated the pipeline by simulating security events, confirming alerts and notifications fired as designed.

Kubernetes Cluster on AWS EKS — Apr 2025

Deployed and managed a Kubernetes cluster on Amazon EKS using CloudFormation and IAM, gaining hands-on experience configuring and scaling containerized workloads securely.

EDUCATION

PMAS-Arid Agriculture University

Oct 2016 – Sep 2020

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology